Policy 13 – Change & Release Management

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2. Policy Objectives and Scope

2.1 Purpose – Deploy code, infrastructure, or configuration changes safely and predictably.

2.2 Scope – Production systems, customer-facing services, shared libraries, and core infrastructure.

2.3 Change Request & Approval

- Create a ticket describing scope, risk, rollback plan.
- Require peer review or manager approval before merge/deploy.

2.4 Testing & Impact Review

- Run unit/integration tests or staging deployment when feasible.
- Assess security impact; add security tests for high-risk changes.

2.5 Release Scheduling & Communication

- Schedule non-urgent releases during low-traffic windows.
- Notify stakeholders at least 24 h in advance for any expected downtime.

2.6 Emergency Change Handling

- Allowed only to restore service or fix critical security flaws.
- Document retrospectively within 24 h and include in next review.

2.7 Post-Implementation Review

- Verify success metrics and error budgets.
- Capture lessons learned in release notes or retro.

3. Policy Compliance

3.1 Compliance Measurement – 100 % production commits have linked approved ticket; failed change rate tracked.

3.2 Exceptions – Emergency path only; must follow 2.6.

3.3 Non-Compliance – Unauthorised change triggers rollback and disciplinary review.

3.4 Continual Improvement – Analyse change-failure trends quarterly; refine pipeline.